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Section Title(S): LINKED SIBS AND PRIVILEGED FAMILIARITY

The Wamangi are the *watani* of the Wambunga, and vice versa. The term calls for explanation in order to understand better both the joking relationship and cross-cousin marriage, of which latter infra.

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The singular of *watani* is *mtani*. *Mtani* is one of the two names by which a person calls his or her cross-cousin, the child of his or her mother's brother or father's sister, and by which he or she is called by him or her. It is by the same name, *mtani*, that you call a member of a sib which has the joking relationship with your own sib. Cross-cousins also call each other *binam*, but members of sibs between which the joking relationship exists do not call each other *binam*. In other words, cross-cousins may call each other either *mtani* or *binam*, but members of sibs between which the joking relationship obtains may call each other *mtani*, never *binam*. So far as I can see, *mtani* is a Bantu word, *binam* an Arabic one.

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Those who by reason of their sib joking relationship call one another *watani* may also be called *wagongo*, that is, those on whom one depends. When a person dies, it is his or her *watani* (of the sib with which his or her sib has the joking relationship) who look after the death rites. Thus when a death occurs the one sib depends on the other with which it has the joking relationship, and in this sense the *watani* are *wagongo*.

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Sibs between which privileged familiarity or the joking relationship prevails are said to *kutaniana*. The translation "joking relationship" may not be a first-

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class literal one. The word *kutaniana* conveys the idea of “playing with each other”, or of “joking at each other”, or even of “insulting each other”. The verb is *tana*. Its applied form is *tania*. The *-na* is the reciprocal suffix, showing that the action is between people. Thus, for example, *piga* means to “hit”, *pigana*, to “hit each other”,—and so for all other verbs.

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